

**UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION**

**Interconnection of Large Loads to the
Interstate Transmission System.**

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Docket No. RM26-4-000

COMMENTS OF META PLATFORMS, INC.

I. INTRODUCTION

Meta Platforms, Inc., (“Meta”) appreciates the opportunity to provide comments on the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission’s (“Commission”) Advance Notice of Proposed Rulemaking (“ANOPR”) on the interconnection of large loads to the interstate transmission system. The ANOPR comes at a critical time. The United States is widely recognized today as the global leader in artificial intelligence (“AI”). But maintaining that edge will require satisfying AI’s growing computational demands, and with that the energy infrastructure needs as well. Winning the AI race calls for continued efforts by federal and state regulators, the power sector, and large load developers to ensure the United States remains conducive and attractive to innovation and large data center investment. Large load interconnection practices in particular vary widely across the country and would benefit from more standardization, better alignment of costs and benefits, and greater transparency.

Meta would like to emphasize three points for the Commission’s consideration:

First, the Commission should consider adopting guidance, best practices, and, if appropriate, minimum standards for large load interconnection rather than promulgating a binding, detailed rule. Adopting guidance would encourage uniformity in industry practices while allowing for continued private-sector innovation and accommodating the varying stages of data center deployment across the country.

Second, the Commission should refine and build upon certain principles stated in the ANOPR, such as raising the minimum MW threshold for large load interconnection reform and expanding the eligibility criteria for expedited interconnection.

Third, the Commission should provide clear guidance on the interconnection of co-located resources and other arrangements that coordinate large load and incremental generation, such as streamlining interconnection study processes, developing fair and efficient cost-allocation methodologies for behind-the-meter configurations, and providing clarity on when co-located facilities can proceed without initial utility or grid operator approval.

Meta thanks the Commission and the Department of Energy for prioritizing large load interconnection and examining methods for improving and standardizing interconnection processes to drive more efficient integration of load. We look forward to working with the Commission and other stakeholders on this important set of issues.

II. ABOUT META

Meta is an industry leader in data center development and has substantial experience with large load interconnection. We have designed, constructed, and operated data centers in the United States since 2010, creating tens of thousands of jobs and enabling development of AI capabilities that are driving our growth. Of Meta’s 30 publicly announced data centers, 26 are located in the United States, and for more than a decade Meta has worked closely with local and state governments, utilities and other energy providers to plan for our energy needs and secure all necessary agreements well in advance of our data centers coming online.¹

¹ Meta, *Global Data Center Fleet*, <https://datacenters.atmeta.com/all-locations/> (last visited Nov. 20, 2025).

III. COMMENTS

A. The Need for Reform of Large Load Interconnection Processes

Meta appreciates the Commission's and the Department of Energy's efforts to update and standardize large load interconnection procedures and agreements. Data center developers and other sources of large load need faster, transparent, and more predictable interconnection processes. The Commission should therefore consider developing minimum standards for the interconnection of large loads and encouraging greater uniformity in the processes that utilities, grid operators, and regulators use to bring data centers online.

The Commission, however, should not rush to impose a one-size-fits-all regulatory solution nationwide. Some regions of the country are just beginning to bring data centers online, while others have already interconnected substantial large data center loads and are working quickly to add more. Keeping this momentum going is imperative. Issuing a detailed, standard rule that fails to account for the diversity in the economic landscape could slow down successful interconnection processes and undermine the Commission's goal of bringing more data centers online faster and in a more orderly manner.²

Meta therefore recommends that the Commission develop guidance, best practices, and, where appropriate, minimum standards as the starting point for improving nationwide interconnection processes for large loads. Large load customers like Meta would benefit most from:

- Clarity on timelines for processing large load interconnection requests;

² The White House, *Winning the Race: America's AI Action Plan* 1 (July 2025) (warning that "onerous regulation" regarding AI infrastructure and development risks "'paralyzing one of the most promising technologies we have seen in generations'" (quoting Vice President Vance, "Remarks by the Vice President at the Artificial Intelligence Action Summit in Paris, France" (Feb. 11, 2025))).

- Clarity on whether the load interconnection queue must operate solely as a first-come, first-served system or, preferably, allow for expedited service in appropriate situations; and
- Interconnection processes that recognize the benefits of co-location and other arrangements that coordinate new load and incremental generation.

As the industry matures and regulators and stakeholders develop more experience in this area, the Commission could consider promulgating binding rules that standardize large load interconnection. But doing so too soon may risk hindering the ongoing private-sector innovation occurring to interconnect large loads and bogging down the efficient interconnection processes that some utilities already use.

B. Comments on Large Load Interconnection Principles in the ANOPR

Meta below provides comments on specific aspects of the Department of Energy’s ANOPR principles.

1. *Minimum threshold for interconnection reform* (*see* para. 19). In paragraph 19, the ANOPR recommends that large load interconnection reforms should apply to “new loads greater than 20 MW.”³ In Meta’s experience, that threshold is too low and would not accurately target the large loads that would most benefit from reform of interconnection processes.⁴ Meta proposes that the Commission instead consider a threshold of 75 MW or higher.⁵

2. *Expedited study processes* (*see* paras. 20 and 24). In paragraph 24, the ANOPR outlines an expedited interconnection study process for large loads in certain circumstances. Meta strongly

³ U.S. Dep’t of Energy, Advanced Notice of Proposed Rulemaking: Ensuring Timely and Orderly Interconnection of Large Loads at P 19 (Oct. 23, 2025).

⁴ *See* Bhargs Srivathsan et al., *AI power: Expanding data center capacity to meet growing demand*, McKinsey & Co., 5 (Oct. 2024) (“Ten years ago, a 30-megawatt (MW) center was considered large. Today, a 200-MW facility is considered normal.”).

⁵ *See, e.g.*, Ethan Howland, *Kansas, Michigan regulators approve large load rules for Evergy, Consumers Energy*, Utility Dive (Nov. 10, 2025) (reporting Kansas large load tariff for “new facilities over 75 MW”).

supports expedited review of facilities that co-locate large loads and generation. Co-location allows large loads to secure electric power quickly, and, in some instances, streamline the build out of necessary transmission infrastructure.⁶ Meta also agrees with the ANOPR’s recommendation in paragraph 20 that large load be studied together with generating facilities⁷—such as by studying “the composite behavior of co-located load and generation”⁸—so long as joint study processes do not delay the interconnection of large loads.⁹

However, utilities should not limit expedited processes to only large loads or hybrid facilities “that agree to be curtailable,” which is discussed in paragraph 24 of the ANOPR.¹⁰ This limitation would be incompatible with the operational requirements of many data centers, which often allow for little downtime over the course of the year.¹¹ The backup sources of generation used by data centers, meanwhile, can be subject to strict regulatory and operational requirements when used for non-emergency deployment (like peak shaving through demand response).¹² Coordination of new load and incremental new generation allows data centers to meet their power

⁶ Johannes Pfeifenberger et al., *Optimizing Grid Infrastructure and Proactive Planning to Support Load Growth and Public Policy Goals*, The Brattle Group, 34–37 (July 2025) (prepared for Clean Air Task Force) (“Brattle Group Rep.”); *see also* discussion *infra* at Part III.C.

⁷ ANOPR at P 20.

⁸ Brattle Group Rep. at 35, 37 (discussing ERCOT’s “integrated process for connecting load and generation that is co-located behind the same point of interconnection (referred to as Private Use Networks, or PUNs)” (citing ERCOT, *Private Use Network (PUN) Capacity Report* (2025))).

⁹ *See also* discussion *infra* at Part III.C.

¹⁰ ANOPR at P 24.

¹¹ Elec. Power Res. Inst. (“EPRI”), *Powering Intelligence: Analyzing Artificial Intelligence and Data Center Energy Consumption* at 2, 15 (2024) (reporting data center “demands for highly reliable power” and that “data centers function ceaselessly” to “facilitate uninterrupted services” and “24/7 availability”); U.S. Dep’t of Energy, *Clean Energy Resources to Meet Data Center Electricity Demand* (reporting that data centers “often require firm power sources to operate continuously”).

¹² *See* U.S. EPA, *Fact Sheet and Frequently Asked Questions: Use of Backup Generators to Maintain the Reliability of the Electric Grid* (May 1, 2025) (discussing 40 C.F.R. §§ 63.6640(f)(4)(ii), 60.4211(f)(3)(i), 60.4243(d)(3)(i)).

demands without resorting to curtailment commitments—and therefore warrants expedited study.¹³

3. *System protection facilities* (*see* para. 23). Meta agrees that interconnection of hybrid facilities should require installation of “the system protection facilities necessary to prevent unauthorized injections or withdrawals that exceed [those] respective rights,” as discussed in paragraph 23 of the ANOPR.¹⁴

C. Further Principles for Interconnection of Coordinated Load and Generation

The Commission’s efforts in this area should recognize the benefits of co-location and other arrangements that coordinate the interconnection of large loads and new generation. First, the Commission should clarify that large load and generation sharing a common point of interconnection do not require additional regulatory hurdles solely due to their co-located configuration. Second, when generation to power large load is sited behind the meter, regulators should use cost-allocation principles that ensure no negative impacts to grid reliability or unfair cost shifts to other customers. Third, the Commission should call on utilities and grid operators to promptly develop streamlined study processes to study large load and incremental generation simultaneously and on an expedited basis. And fourth, the Commission should clarify the conditions under which co-located load and new generation may be sited and initially operated without utility or grid operator approval, in advance of later connection to the grid pursuant to interconnection procedures.

¹³ Brattle Group Rep. at 35–37.

¹⁴ ANOPR at P 23; *see also* Brattle Group Rep. at 35 (recommending same).

IV. CONCLUSION

Meta respectfully requests that the Commission proceed with developing guidance, best practices, and, where appropriate, minimum standards, in keeping with the principles proposed above.

Respectfully submitted,

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